NEIGHBOURWISE AI

Neighborhood Intelligence Report

Dorchester

Boston, Massachusetts

72.4

out of 100

▲ Strength: **Schools**

▼ Weakness: **Universities**

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Discover Dorchester, a vibrant and diverse neighborhood nestled in the heart of Boston, Massachusetts. With a master score of 72.4/100, it's a solid choice for those seeking a blend of urban living and community charm. Dorchester, or "Dot" as the locals affectionately call it, boasts an impressive transit score of 97.0, making it a commuter's paradise with easy access to downtown Boston and beyond. The neighborhood's crowning glory, however, is its top-notch schools, scoring a perfect 100, making it an ideal choice for families and students alike.

Dorchester's housing market, with a score of 74.9, offers a mix of historic homes and modern apartments, catering to a wide range of tastes and budgets. The neighborhood's grocery score of 83.9 ensures that fresh produce and daily essentials are never too far away. However, with a restaurant score of 49.7, Dorchester's culinary scene may not be as vibrant as some other Boston neighborhoods, presenting a trade-off for food enthusiasts.

Despite its lower university score of 47.5, Dorchester's proximity to Boston's rich academic scene ensures that higher education opportunities are still within reach. The neighborhood's safety score of 48.6 is a reflection of its ongoing efforts to improve and maintain a secure environment for its residents. With its Bluebikes score of 99.5, Dorchester is a cyclist's dream, offering a green and healthy way to explore the neighborhood and beyond. In essence, Dorchester is a neighborhood of contrasts and opportunities, best suited for those who value excellent education, convenient transit, and a strong sense of community.

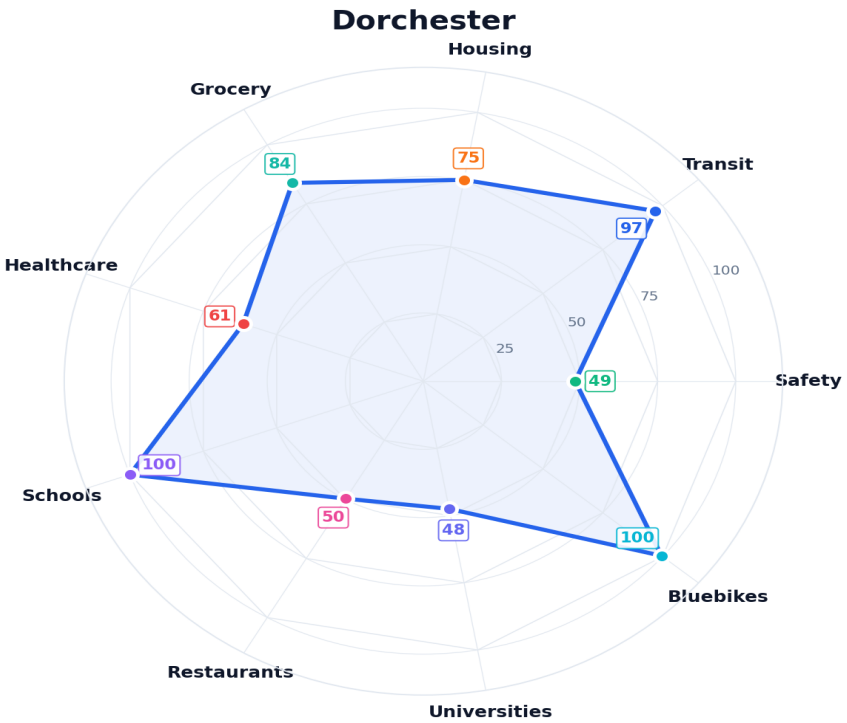
DOMAIN SCORECARD

DOMAIN	SCORE	GRADE
Safety	48.6	Moderate
Transit	97.0	Excellent
Housing	74.9	Affordable
Grocery	83.9	Abundant
Healthcare	61.4	Good
Schools	100.0	Excellent
Restaurants	49.7	Moderate
Universities	47.5	Moderate

Bluebikes	99.5	Excellent

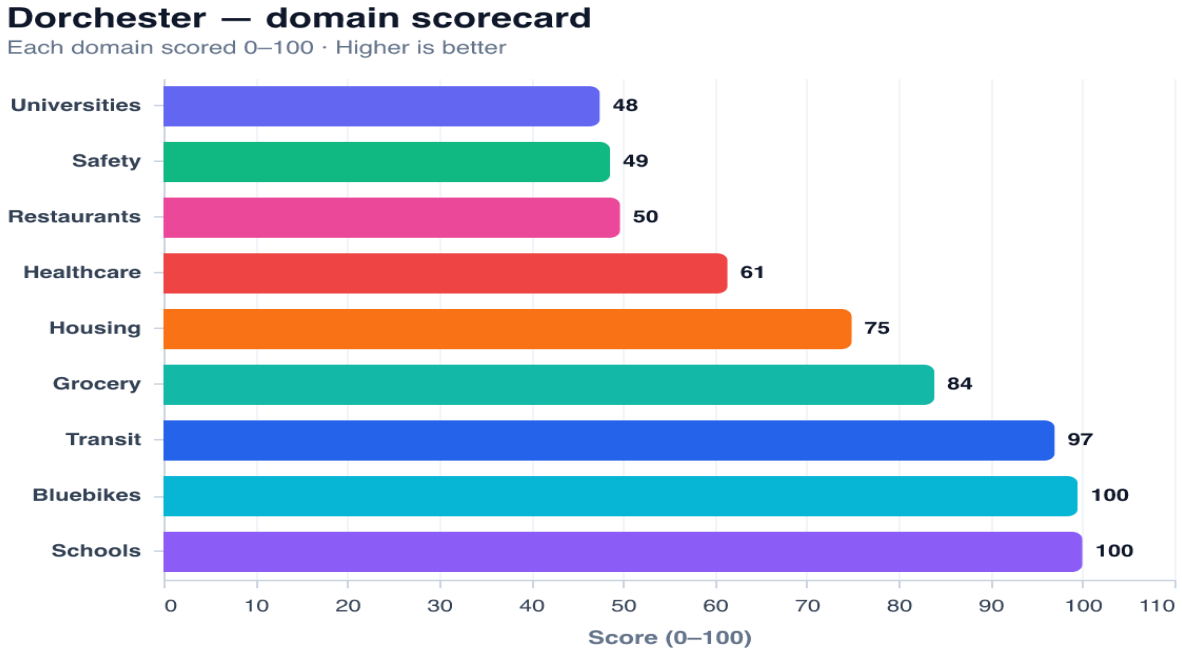
VISUAL ANALYSIS

Domain Radar



Each spoke represents one of the 9 scored domains (0–100).

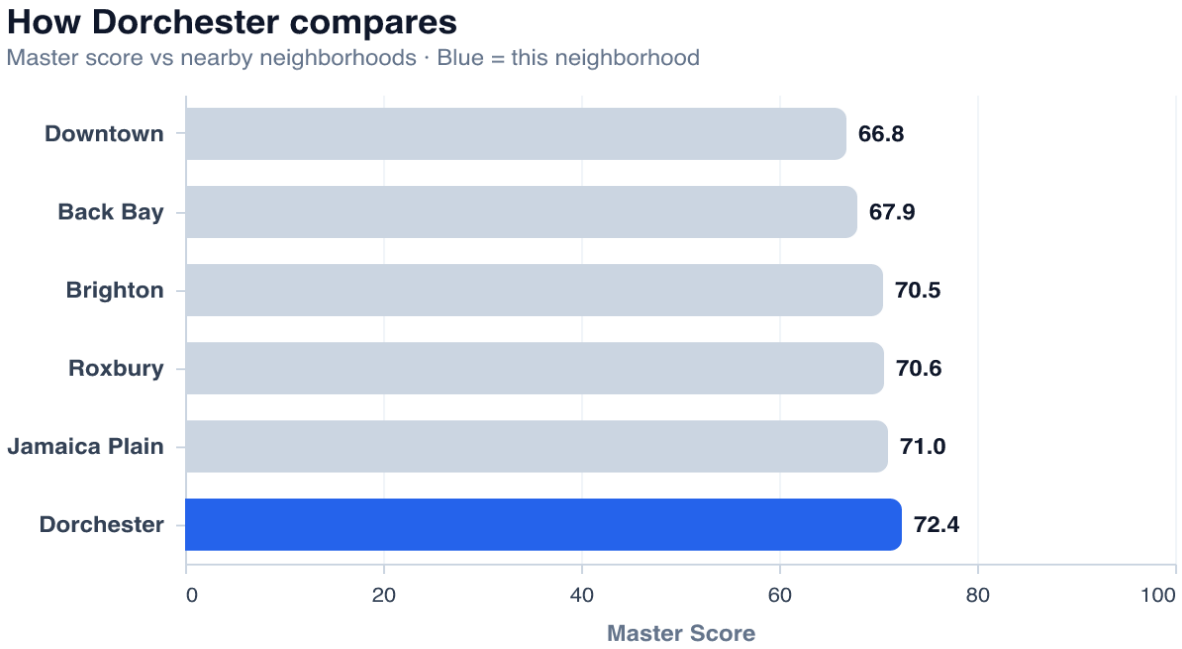
All Domain Scores



Color-coded by domain · Higher = stronger performance.

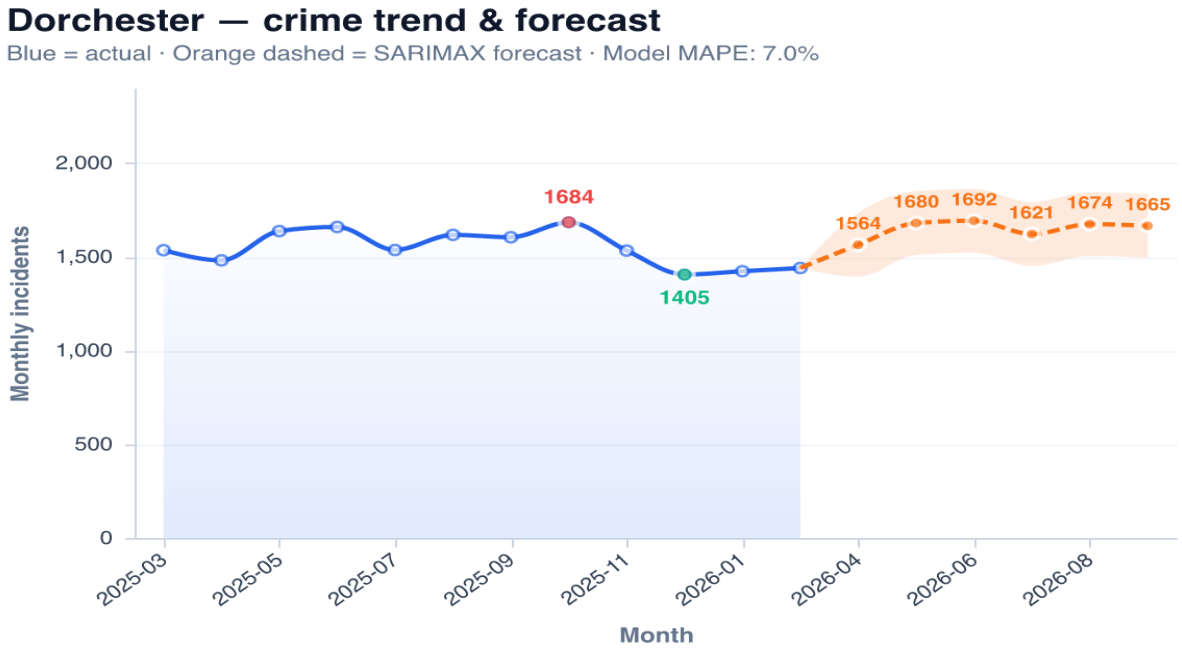
COMPARISON & TRENDS

Neighborhood Comparison



Blue bar = this neighborhood · vs 5 nearest by master score.

Crime Trend & Forecast



Blue = actual · Orange dashed = SARIMAX forecast + CI band.

Trend: Stable · Model MAPE: 7.0% · Reliability: HIGH

In Dorchester, Massachusetts, crime rates have remained stable over the past year, with an average of 1457 monthly crimes. Looking ahead, our forecast suggests a slight increase to approximately 1564 monthly crimes by April 2026. Notably, 81.9% of crimes occur within 145 identified hotspot clusters, indicating that safety measures could be effectively focused within these areas.

DOMAIN ANALYSIS

Safety

In Dorchester, a neighborhood within Boston, Massachusetts, safety is a moderate concern with a score of 48.6 out of 100. The most common police service call is to investigate a person, however, the most prevalent actual crime type is property crime, accounting for 19.30% of all incidents. There has been a slight increase of 1.18% in total incidents year over year, with violent crimes representing a relatively small proportion at 1.13% of all incidents. Residents and visitors should remain vigilant, particularly regarding property crimes, given the high incident rate of 7961.45 per square mile.

Transit

Dorchester, a vibrant neighborhood in Boston, boasts an excellent transit score of 97.0, making it a commuter's paradise. The area is served by the Mattapan Line and the Red Line for rapid transit, connecting residents to key destinations such as Downtown Boston and Quincy Center. In addition, Dorchester offers an extensive network of bus routes, including the Fairmount Line and various loops, providing access to local attractions like the Franklin Park Zoo and the John F. Kennedy Presidential Library and Museum. With a total of 333 stops, including 7 rapid transit stops and 325 bus stops, 96.1% of which are wheelchair accessible, Dorchester's public transportation system is both comprehensive and inclusive.

Restaurants

Dorchester, a neighborhood in Boston, Massachusetts, offers a moderate restaurant scene with a diverse range of cuisines, from American and Italian to Asian and Caribbean. With a density of 109.74 restaurants per square mile, diners have ample choices among its 800 establishments, although the quality varies with only 30.5% rated as high quality. The area caters to various budgets with a good mix of budget, mid-range, and upscale options, and nearly 80% of the restaurants offer delivery services.

Universities

Dorchester, a neighborhood in Boston, Massachusetts, offers moderate access to education with a score of 47.5 out of 100. The area hosts two educational institutions: Jupiter Beauty Academy, a private vocational school, and the University of Massachusetts Boston, a public research university. The University of Massachusetts Boston provides opportunities for higher education, including bachelor's and doctorate degrees, and also offers campus housing for students.

LIFESTYLE & CHARACTER

Dorchester, a vibrant neighborhood in Boston, Massachusetts, is a melting pot of cultures, predominantly Black and Latinx. The area is marked by its unique commuting challenges, with residents facing some of the longest travel times in the city, despite its relative proximity to employment centers. This is largely due to the lack of rapid transit services, with the neighborhood primarily served by buses. The reliance on bus transportation, which consumes the most time, significantly extends the daily commute for Dorchester's residents. This stark contrast is evident when compared to predominantly White neighborhoods such as Back Bay, Beacon Hill, Fenway, and the West End, which enjoy better access to rapid transit services.

The daily life in Dorchester is shaped by these commuting challenges, which are a testament to the broader issues of access and equity in the city. The neighborhood's residents have voiced their concerns at community engagement meetings, highlighting the impact of these lengthy commutes on their daily lives. Despite these challenges, Dorchester remains a resilient community, contributing to approximately 19% of all trips beginning in Boston each day. The neighborhood's character is defined by its tenacity and the strong sense of community that has developed in the face of these adversities. This unique blend of vibrant culture and shared challenges makes Dorchester a distinctive part of Boston's urban fabric.

WHO SHOULD LIVE HERE?

1. The neighborhood of Dorchester in Boston, Massachusetts, seems to be most suitable for families. This is primarily due to the excellent school score of 100.0, indicating high-quality education, and the decent housing score of 74.9, suggesting reasonable housing options.

2. Retirees might want to look elsewhere as the healthcare score is relatively low at 61.4, which could indicate less access to quality healthcare facilities. Additionally, the safety score of 48.6 might be a concern for those seeking a more secure environment.

Data: Analyze Boston API · Cambridge Open Data · FBI Crime Data Explorer · MBTA GTFS · Snowflake Cortex · NeighbourWise RAG · Scores normalized 0–100 across 51 neighborhoods · Generated April 10, 2026 · DAMG7374